

Historic Dancing



Historic Dancing

GRADE(S): 7-12



About the Course

Students will learn dances that were popular in the historical period being studied and perform them to some music of that period.

This topic is included in the following course(s): PE: Grades 7-12

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Lessons specifically created for Grades 7-12. We do recommend you prioritize the Historical Dance lessons as these are less likely to be obtained elsewhere and also give depth and richness to student's understanding of the time period. We recommend you make sure to include some sort of physical activity as breaks throughout your school day. If you already have sports or similar activities as a regular part of your life rhythms, these lessons are optional.



Placement & Combining Tips

This course is suitable for interested students in Grades 5-6 if combining.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
7-12	Historic Dancing 1 time/week 20 min	

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
PE: Grades 7-12				
Playground Games	Free Play/ Circuits	Sports	Free Play/ Circuits	Historic Dancing



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

(No Quick Links Assigned)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



SAMPLE

Historic Dancing

How To Teach



Overview

Mason emphasized that being physically fit is just as important as being mentally and spiritually fit. She used a combination of Swedish Drill (calisthenic exercises done to music or military-style commands), playground games, sports, dance, free play, and afternoon walks to make sure students had time for vigorous exercise every single day.



Introduce

Teach students the new song, dance, or sport. Tutorials are often provided.



Practice

Play your new game, practice your new dance, sing your new rhyme, etc.!



Term 1

WEEK 1 20m Historic Dancing - Lesson 1

Sir Roger de Coverley

PREP: Watch instructional video to familiarize yourself with dance. Print Sir Roger de Coverley Instructions PDF.

→ INTRO

Sir Roger de Coverley is an English Country Dance originally published in *The Dancing Master* in 1695. It was widely danced in the 1700s and remained popular through the 1800s. It is most famously found in Charles Dickens's *A Christmas Carol*, at Fezziwig's ball. It is a finishing dance that was commonly danced at the end of a ball, where all attendees partnered up to close out the evening. It promoted good humor among the company and caused them all to leave having great satisfaction with one another. After the dance crossed the ocean and came over to America, it morphed into different variations and also became what we now know as the Virginia Reel. You will recognize the structure and formations as they have similarities.

→ VIEW

Watch the example of Sir Roger de Coverley. *Please note that there are many versions of Sir Roger de Coverley. Our example video differs from our instructional video.*

∞ Video Link: Sir Roger de Coverley

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Using Instructional Video, form pairs, designate diagonals, and learn Part 1 (meet in middle, right hand turn, left hand turn) without music. Instructor will need to cue dancers and count in 6's.

It is often helpful for the students to remain with the same partner week to week while learning the piece. Once mastered, they can change partners.

∞ Video Link: Instructional Sir Roger de Coverley

∞ PDF Link: Sir Roger de Coverley Instructions PDF

WEEK 2 20m Historic Dancing - Lesson 2

Sir Roger de Coverley

→ REVIEW

Review head couple, diagonal 1, and diagonal 2. Review part 1 with diagonals (meet in middle, right hand turn, left hand).

→ LEARN

Learn the rest of Part 1 (2 hand turn and dos-a-dos).

→ PRACTICE

The entire Part 1 together without music.

∞ Video Link: Instructional Sir Roger de Coverley

WEEK 3 20m Historic Dancing - Lesson 3

Sir Roger de Coverley

→ REVIEW

Entire Part 1.

→ LEARN

Part 2 Weaving and Promenade/Cast off.

→ PRACTICE

Parts 1 and 2 together without music.

∞ Video Link: Instructional Sir Roger de Coverley